

be based on detailed time records. (*Crespin v. Shewry* (2004) 125 Cal.App.4th 259, 272.) Absent detailed billing records, the court will deny the motion.

Plaintiff to submit billing records, with redactions if necessary, by October 30, 2026.

2.

CASE #	CASE NAME	HEARING NAME
CVRI2304403	KANDILIAN VS BMW NORTH AMERICA, LLC	MOTION FOR PROTECTIVE ORDER

Tentative Ruling:

GRANT, in part, as modified.

A Protective Order shall issue ordering as follows:

(1) If the deposition is to be conducted via Zoom, all individuals participating in the deposition are required to turn their cameras on and identify themselves for the record. “Participating” includes simply observing the deposition and not actively questioning the deponent. (2) Both sides are limited to no more than five (5) attorneys each at the deposition. (3) The Zoom link to be used shall be password protected.

3.

CASE #	CASE NAME	HEARING NAME
CVRI2304403	KANDILIAN VS BMW NORTH AMERICA, LLC	MOTION TO COMPEL

Tentative Ruling:

GRANT the motion. The deposition of Defendant’s expert, Travis Brown, shall go forward at a mutually convenient date within 30 days from today’s date. The deposition shall be subject to the protective order issued by the court today (*supra*).

4.

CASE #	CASE NAME	HEARING NAME
CVRI2505351	MOLINA VS GENERAL MOTORS LLC, A DELAWARE LIMITED LIABILITY COMPANY	MOTION FOR ATTORNEYS FEES

Tentative Ruling:

GRANT Plaintiffs’ motion for attorney fees and costs in the reduced, reasonable amount of **\$8,190.99** (\$7,140.00 in attorney fees plus \$1,050.99 in costs), payable to Plaintiff’s counsel within 30 days.

Plaintiff counsel's requested hourly rates are excessive for the Riverside geographic area. The hourly rate permitted shall be reduced to \$350 per hour. The court will strike Attorney Whelan's entry of 0.9 for pre-retention services. Attorney fees are only recoverable once the attorney-client relationship has been established. The court will strike 0.6 hours from Attorney Valitskaya's billing for administrative and clerical tasks, such as scheduling depositions, updating internal case files, and drafting internal memoranda. Counsel also seeks 7 hours of attorney time for "wrap-up fees" (to review the opposition, draft a reply, and attend the hearing on the fee motion). This is excessive. Attorney Pridham has already billed 3 hours to draft the fee motion. There is no reason that such a routine fee motion should take more than 4 hours to draft and defend. The court will strike 6 hours from the wrap-up fee request. Hence, the court awards fees for Timothy Whelan of \$2,625 (7.5 hours at \$350 per hour), for Aliaksandra Valitskaya of \$3,115 (8.9 hours at \$350 per hour), for Grenville Pridham of \$1,050 (3 hours at \$350 per hour) and for 1 hour of wrap-up for \$350. Total billable time is 20.4 hours at \$350 per hour for total attorney fees of \$7,140. No multiplier is warranted or awarded.

Plaintiff is also awarded the entire claimed costs of \$1,050, as the costs requested are recoverable.

The total award to Plaintiff for fees and costs is \$8,190.99.

The court orders that the Memorandum of Costs filed by Plaintiff on 7/26/26 be stricken so as to prevent double recovery of court costs.